

Probability Theory

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These are my notes on probability theory, which I am studying for C271A and as an extension of what I learned in analysis. I hope to cover the relevant measure theory whenever possible, and I will also add completed practice problems as well.

Textbooks Used to Develop these Notes:

1. ***Probability: Theory and Examples*** - Rick Durrett
2. ***Real Analysis*** - Gerald Folland

Other Textbooks Referenced:

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NOTE: Any sections/subsections marked with an asterisk are extra sections and have been added to this document as extensions of introduced theory.

1 Probability Spaces

1.1 Algebras and Rings

We begin with some basic measure theory which will motivate the formulation of the σ -algebra and allow us to go from generality to specificity in defining probability spaces.

We begin by defining a probability space as a triple $(\Omega, \mathcal{F}, P)$. The first element Ω is called the set of outcomes or the "sample space", which is just an underlying set that can be defined as we wish.

Definition 1.1 (σ -algebra). *The second element $\mathcal{F}$ is called a σ -algebra, satisfying the following properties:*

1. $\Omega \in \mathcal{F}$
2. $\forall S, P \in \mathcal{F} : S \setminus P \in \mathcal{F}$
3. *The countable (finite or countably infinite) union of sets in $\mathcal{F}$ is in $\mathcal{F}$:*

$$\forall \{S_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in \mathcal{F}^{\mathbb{N}} : \bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n \in \mathcal{F}$$

We can equivalently replace this condition with closure under disjoint unions.

We call the set S an event (specifically an event with an assigned probability, which we shall see later). We also define an algebra over sets $\mathcal{A}$, which weakens condition 3 to finite unions.

Lemma 1.1. *We can derive other properties of sets in the σ -algebra, such as:*

1. $\emptyset \in \mathcal{F}$
2. $\forall \{S_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in \mathcal{F}^{\mathbb{N}} :$

$$\bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n \in \mathcal{F}$$

3. $\forall S \in \mathcal{F} : \Omega \setminus S \in \mathcal{F}$

These properties also hold for algebras in the finite sense.

Proof. σ -algebras: For $\emptyset \in \mathcal{F}$, this follows from the fact that $\Omega \in \mathcal{F}$ and from property two, $\Omega \setminus \Omega = \emptyset \in \mathcal{F}$.

The second statement follows from DeMorgan's Laws. If $S_n \in \mathcal{F}$, then $S_n^c \in \mathcal{F}$, which tells us that:

$$\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n^c = \left(\bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n \right)^c \in \mathcal{F}$$

Once again by the complement axiom, we see that:

$$\bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n \in \mathcal{F}$$

As for the third statement, we know that since $\Omega \in \mathcal{F}$, then we have that for all $S \in \mathcal{F}$, that $\Omega \setminus S \in \mathcal{F}$. $\square$

Proof. Algebras: $\emptyset \in \mathcal{F}$ follows from property 2.

Since $\Omega \in \mathcal{F}$, we have that $\forall S \in \mathcal{F} : \Omega \setminus S \in \mathcal{F}$. So, for any finite collection $\{S_i\}_{i=0}^n$, we have that $S_i^c \in \mathcal{F}$:

$$\bigcup_{i=0}^n S_i^c \in \mathcal{F} \implies \left(\bigcup_{i=0}^n S_i^c \right)^c = \bigcap_{i=0}^n S_i \in \mathcal{F}$$

□

Lemma 1.2. *The intersection of a family of σ -algebras for a set Ω is a σ -algebra.*

Proof. Let us call the family $\{\mathcal{F}_\alpha : \alpha \in I\}$ such that we have valid measurable spaces $(\Omega, \mathcal{F}_\alpha)$, then:

$$\mathcal{F} := \bigcap_{\alpha \in I} \mathcal{F}_\alpha$$

is a valid sigma algebra such that $(\Omega, \mathcal{F})$ is a measurable space. We see that:

$$\forall \alpha \in I : \Omega \in \mathcal{F}_\alpha \implies \Omega \in \bigcap_{\alpha \in I} \mathcal{F}_\alpha$$

so property 1 in Definition 1.1 is fulfilled. Now, for some S in the intersection:

$$\begin{aligned} S \in \bigcap_{\alpha \in I} \mathcal{F}_\alpha &\iff \forall \alpha \in I : S \in \mathcal{F}_\alpha \\ &\implies \forall \alpha \in I : S^c \in \mathcal{F}_\alpha \iff S^c \in \bigcap_{\alpha \in I} \mathcal{F}_\alpha \end{aligned}$$

thus property 2 is fulfilled. Now consider some $\{S_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in \mathcal{F}^{\mathbb{N}}$, then:

$$\begin{aligned} \forall n \in \mathbb{N} : S_n \in \mathcal{F} &\implies \forall \alpha \in I : S_n \in \mathcal{F}_\alpha \\ \implies \forall \alpha \in I : \{S_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in \mathcal{F}_\alpha^{\mathbb{N}} &\implies \forall \alpha \in I : \bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n \in \mathcal{F}_\alpha \\ &\implies \bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n \in \mathcal{F} \end{aligned}$$

so we have verified property 3. This is quite similar to topologies, where the intersection of topologies is a topology, but the union is not necessarily a topology. □

Consider some sample space $\Omega := \{1, 2, 3, 4\}$, then consider:

$$\mathcal{F}_1 := \{\Omega, \emptyset, \{1\}, \{2, 3, 4\}\}$$

$$\mathcal{F}_2 := \{\Omega, \emptyset, \{2\}, \{1, 3, 4\}\}$$

both of which are σ -algebras. If we take the intersection:

$$\mathcal{F}_3 := \mathcal{F}_1 \cap \mathcal{F}_2 = \{\Omega, \emptyset\}$$

which is the "coarsest" or trivial σ -algebra. Now taking the union:

$$\mathcal{F}_1 \cup \mathcal{F}_2 = \{\Omega, \emptyset, \{1\}, \{2\}, \{2, 3, 4\}, \{1, 3, 4\}\}$$

but by Definition 1.1 property 3, we would need $\{1, 2\}$ to belong in the union, thus the union is not necessarily a σ -algebra.

An example of a σ -algebra is the countable σ -algebra, defined as:

$$\mathcal{F} := \{S \subseteq \Omega : S \text{ countable} \vee S^c \text{ countable}\}$$

Proof. We have that $\Omega \in \mathcal{F}$ since $\emptyset$ is trivially countable. Now consider some $S \in \mathcal{F}$, then if S is countable, we know that $(S^c)^c$ is countable, thus $S^c \in \mathcal{F}$. If S is not countable, then we know that S^c must be countable, so $S^c \in \mathcal{F}$.

Now take a countable union of sets in the sequence $\{S_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in \mathcal{F}^{\mathbb{N}}$. If each S_n is countable, then it follows that the union is in $\mathcal{F}$ from the fact that countable union of countable sets is countable. If each S_n is not countable, then:

$$\left(\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n \right)^c = \bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n^c \in \mathcal{F}$$

since S_n not countable and $S_n \in \mathcal{F}$ means S_n^c is countable. Assume some are countable and some are not, then for the S_i that are not countable, we have that S_i^c is countable. This forces the complement of the union to be countable. $\square$

Definition 1.2. Given a space Ω and some set $S \subseteq \mathcal{P}(\Omega)$, we define the minimal algebra generated by S as:

$$\mathcal{F}(S) := \bigcap_{S \subseteq \mathcal{F}} \mathcal{F}$$

which is an algebra as per Lemma 1.2.

Consider two subsets $P \subseteq S \subseteq \mathcal{P}(\Omega)$, then we know that:

$$P \subseteq S \subseteq \mathcal{F}(S) \implies \mathcal{F}(P) \subseteq \mathcal{F}(S)$$

Since $\mathcal{F}(S)$ is a σ -algebra containing P thus belongs in the intersection of the minimal σ -algebra containing P . We say the Borel σ -algebra on $\mathbb{R}$ is one that is generated by the set of all open intervals:

$$I := \{(a, b) : (\forall a, b \in \mathbb{R} : a < b)\} \subseteq \mathcal{P}(\mathbb{R})$$

$$\mathcal{B} := \mathcal{F}(I)$$

The motivation of defining $\mathcal{B}$ as a minimal algebra of an algebra generated by open intervals is to essentially "hope" that unmeasurable/pathological sets like the Vitali set are eliminated from question. $\mathcal{B}$ will contain open intervals, closed intervals, and countable unions and intersections of them (so Cantor type sets are also included).

The issue is, while the Borel σ -algebra gives us candidates for what sets are measurable, it does not give the existence of a measure in $\mathbb{R}$.

Consider the minimal σ -algebra of an already existing σ -algebra $\mathcal{G}$, with the minimal σ -algebra being $\mathcal{F}(\mathcal{G})$. Then:

$$\mathcal{F}(\mathcal{G}) := \bigcap_{\mathcal{G} \subseteq \mathcal{F}} \mathcal{F}$$

By definition, we have that $\mathcal{G} \subseteq \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{G})$. However, since $\mathcal{G} \subseteq \mathcal{G}$, then we have that:

$$\mathcal{F}(\mathcal{G}) \subseteq \mathcal{G} \implies \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{G}) = \mathcal{G}$$

We introduce a few more concepts:

Definition 1.3. A ring $\mathcal{R} \subseteq \mathcal{P}(\Omega)$ is an algebra without the condition that $\Omega \in \mathcal{R}$. A σ -ring $\mathcal{R}_\sigma$ is a σ -algebra without the same condition.

Lemma 1.3. *Properties of rings:*

1. *Rings (and respectively σ -rings) are closed under (countable) intersections*

Proof. Property One: Consider a ring $\mathcal{R}$ and a finite collection of sets $\{S_i\}_{i=0}^n \in \mathcal{R}^{n+1}$. We prove by induction, consider the base case $n = 1$. Then:

$$S_1 \cap S_0 = S_1 \setminus (S_1 \setminus S_0)$$

Since $S_1, S_0 \in \mathcal{R}$, then $S_1 \setminus S_0 \in \mathcal{R}$ and applying the set difference property again, we obtain that the intersection is in the ring. Now assume this to be true for some $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Then for $n + 1$:

$$\bigcap_{i=0}^{n+1} S_i = S_{n+1} \cap \bigcap_{i=0}^n S_i = S_{n+1} \setminus \left(S_{n+1} \setminus \bigcap_{i=0}^n S_i \right) \in \mathcal{R}$$

Now consider a σ -ring $\mathcal{R}_\sigma$ and a sequence of sets $\{S_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in \mathcal{R}_\sigma^{\mathbb{N}}$. We know that:

$$\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n \in \mathcal{R}_\sigma$$

Now by the finite set difference property, we know that $E \setminus S_n \in \mathcal{R}_\sigma$, so their countable union is in the ring too. Now:

$$E \setminus \bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} (E \setminus S_n) = E \cap \left(\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} (E \setminus S_n) \right)^c = E \cap \bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} (E \setminus S_n)^c = E \cap \bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n$$

If we set $E = S_0$, then:

$$S_0 \cap \bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n = \bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n \in \mathcal{R}_\sigma$$

by once again applying the set difference property to E setminus the countable union (in the case that $E = S_0$). $\square$

1.1.1 Problems (Folland and Durrett)

Folland 1.2.1D: If $\mathcal{R}_\sigma$ is a σ -ring, then $\mathcal{F} := \{E \subseteq X : (\forall F \in \mathcal{R}_\sigma : E \cap F \in \mathcal{R}_\sigma)\}$ is a σ -algebra:

Proof. First we observe that X is in $\mathcal{F}$ since for all $F \in \mathcal{R}_\sigma$, we have that $X \cap F = F \in \mathcal{R}_\sigma$. Now, consider any $E, G \in \mathcal{F}$ such that:

$$\forall F \in \mathcal{R}_\sigma : E \cap F \in \mathcal{R}_\sigma \wedge G \cap F \in \mathcal{R}_\sigma$$

Then by set difference properties of the σ -ring, we have that:

$$(E \cap F) \setminus (G \cap F) \in \mathcal{R}_\sigma \implies (E \cap F) \cap (G^c \cup F^c) = E \cap G^c \cap F = (E \setminus G) \cap F \in \mathcal{R}_\sigma$$

thus $E \setminus G \in \mathcal{F}$. Finally, we must prove closure under countable union. Take a sequence $\{E_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in \mathcal{F}^{\mathbb{N}}$ such that:

$$\begin{aligned} \forall F \in \mathcal{R}_\sigma, \forall n \in \mathbb{N} : E_n \cap F \in \mathcal{R}_\sigma \\ F \cap \bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} E_n = \bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} (F \cap E_n) \end{aligned}$$

Since $F \cap E_n \in \mathcal{R}_\sigma$ for each E_n , then by closure under countable union of the σ -ring, we have that the countable union of E_n is in $\mathcal{F}$. Thus $\mathcal{F}$ is a σ -algebra. Here we used a σ -ring to describe a σ -algebra, a similar technique to what is used in Caratheodory's Extension Theorem. $\square$

Folland 1.2.5: If $\mathcal{M}$ is the σ -algebra generated by $E \subseteq \mathcal{P}(X)$, then $\mathcal{M}$ is the union of the σ -algebras generated by S as S ranges over all countable subsets of E . In other words, we want to show:

$$\mathcal{F}(E) = \bigcup_{\alpha \in I} \mathcal{F}(S_\alpha)$$

Proof. Since $E \subseteq \mathcal{F}(E)$, we have that:

$$\forall \alpha \in I : S_\alpha \subseteq E \implies \forall \alpha \in I : \mathcal{F}(S_\alpha) \subseteq \mathcal{F}(E) \implies \bigcup_{\alpha \in I} \mathcal{F}(S_\alpha) \subseteq \mathcal{F}(E)$$

For the reverse inclusion, we show that the union is a sigma algebra itself. The space X is trivially in the union. If we take some P in the union, then:

$$\exists \alpha \in I : P \in \mathcal{F}(S_\alpha) \implies P^c \in \mathcal{F}(S_\alpha) \implies P^c \in \bigcup_{\alpha \in I} \mathcal{F}(S_\alpha)$$

Now consider some sequence $\{P_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ made from elements in the union. Then we have that:

$$\forall n \in \mathbb{N}, \exists \alpha \in I : P_n \in \mathcal{F}(S_\alpha)$$

Denote each of these α as α_n based on the corresponding set P_n . Then we have that:

$$\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_{\alpha_n}$$

is a countable union of countable subsets of E and thus is a countable subset of E , so there must exist some α' such that:

$$\forall n \in \mathbb{N} : S_{\alpha_n} \subseteq \bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_{\alpha_n} = S_{\alpha'} \implies \mathcal{F}(S_{\alpha_n}) \subseteq \mathcal{F}(S_{\alpha'})$$

Thus there exists an $\alpha' \in I$ such that:

$$\forall n \in \mathbb{N} : P_n \in \mathcal{F}(S_{\alpha'}) \subseteq \bigcup_{\alpha \in I} \mathcal{F}(S_\alpha)$$

so the union is a valid σ -algebra. Now if we define $E := \{E_\beta : \beta \in J\}$, then we know that:

$$\forall \beta \in J, \exists \alpha'' \in I : E_\beta \in \mathcal{F}(S_{\alpha''})$$

where the countable subset of E is simply $\{E_\beta\}$ for that specific $\beta \in J$. Thus:

$$E \subseteq \bigcup_{\alpha \in I} S_\alpha \subseteq \bigcup_{\alpha \in I} \mathcal{F}(S_\alpha) \implies \mathcal{F}(E) \subseteq \bigcup_{\alpha \in I} \mathcal{F}(S_\alpha)$$

where we once again applied the subset property and the fact that the σ -algebra generated by a σ -algebra is itself. Then if we take some $C \in \mathcal{F}(E)$, we have that:

$$\exists \alpha \in I : C \in \mathcal{F}(S_\alpha)$$

So any set in the σ -algebra generated by a possibly large (uncountable), complex set can be in the simpler σ -algebra generated by a countable subset of the set. $\square$

Durrett 1.1.1:

Durrett 1.1.2: Show that $\mathcal{F}(S_d) = \mathcal{B}^d$ where $\mathcal{B}$ is the Borel set of $\mathbb{R}$. Where S_d is defined as:

Durrett 1.1.3:

Durrett 1.1.5:

1.2 Measure

The third and final element of the triple is P , which we call the probability measure. A measure is defined as a following:

Definition 1.4. $(X, \mathcal{F})$ is a measurable space on which we can put a measure $\mu : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ with the properties:

1. $\forall S \in \mathcal{F} : \mu(S) \geq 0 \wedge \mu(\emptyset) = 0$

Note that we could also equivalently replace the second part with $\mu(\emptyset) \in [0, \infty)$.

2. Given some $\{S_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in \mathcal{F}^{\mathbb{N}}$, if:

$$\forall i \neq j : S_i \cap S_j = \emptyset \implies \mu\left(\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n\right) = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mu(S_n)$$

This second property will be quite important, and we shall call it countable additivity. Countable additivity gives a reason as to why we wanted property 3 in Definition 1.1, where:

$$\forall \{S_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in \mathcal{F}^{\mathbb{N}} : \bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n \in \mathcal{F}$$

If this were not true, then we could have had some sequence of S_n in the σ -algebra where their countably infinite union is not measurable, so property 2 in this definition would not always hold.

Lemma 1.4. This definition of a measure reveals additional properties:

1. Monotonicity:

$$\forall A, B \in \mathcal{F} : A \subseteq B \implies \mu(A) \leq \mu(B)$$

2. Subadditivity:

$$\forall \{S_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in \mathcal{F}^{\mathbb{N}} : \mu\left(\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n\right) \leq \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mu(S_n)$$

3. Continuity from below:

$$\forall n \in \mathbb{N} : S_n \subseteq S_{n+1} \implies \mu\left(\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n\right) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \mu(S_n)$$

4. Continuity from above:

$$\forall n \in \mathbb{N} : S_{n+1} \subseteq S_n \wedge \mu(S_0) < \infty \implies \mu\left(\bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n\right) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \mu(S_n)$$

Proof. Take the sets $A, B \setminus A$, then:

$$\mu(B) = \mu(A \cup (B \setminus A)) = \mu(A) + \mu(B \setminus A) \geq \mu(A)$$

thus proving the first property of non-negativity. Here we used countable additivity with the sequence $A, B \setminus A, \emptyset, \emptyset, \dots$ to bring about finite additivity. This means the proof also requires that the measure $\mu(\emptyset) = 0$.

For the second property, we can rewrite the union as the following:

$$\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n = \bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \left(S_n \setminus \bigcup_{i=0}^{n-1} S_i \right)$$

The reverse inclusion is trivial. For the forward inclusion, if x is in the union of S_n , then:

$$\exists n \in \mathbb{N} : x \in S_n$$

but it might be that x belongs to the intersection of multiple such sets, so by well ordering property and nonemptiness above, we can define:

$$m := \min\{n \in \mathbb{N} : x \in S_n\}$$

So $x \in S_m$ which also tells us that for all $n \leq m$ that $x \notin S_n$, so:

$$\exists m \in \mathbb{N} : x \in S_m \setminus \bigcup_{i=0}^{m-1} S_i$$

We also have the added benefit that each set difference is disjoint from any other. So:

$$\mu \left(\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n \right) = \mu \left(\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \left(S_n \setminus \bigcup_{i=0}^{n-1} S_i \right) \right) = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mu \left(S_n \setminus \bigcup_{i=0}^{n-1} S_i \right) \leq \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mu(S_n)$$

Now observe we can do the following rewrite:

$$\sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mu \left(S_n \setminus \bigcup_{i=0}^{n-1} S_i \right) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \sum_{i=0}^n \mu \left(S_i \setminus \bigcup_{j=0}^{i-1} S_j \right)$$

Countable additivity gives us finite additivity (simply consider a sequence $A_0, A_1, A_2, \dots, A_n, \emptyset, \emptyset, \dots$), so we can rewrite the sum as:

$$= \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \mu \left(\bigcup_{i=0}^n S_i \right) = \mu \left(\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_i \right)$$

The reason why the third and fourth properties are dubbed "continuity" is because they essentially explain a limit exchange under certain sufficient conditions, where:

$$\mu \left(\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_i \right) = \mu \left(\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} S_n \right) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \mu(S_n)$$

The proof follows simply from our observation before. Due to the nesting where $S_0 \subseteq S_1 \subseteq \dots$, we have that:

$$\bigcup_{i=0}^n S_i = S_n$$

By the monotonicity property, we have that $\{\mu(S_n)\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ is a non-decreasing sequence, so we can rewrite the limit as:

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \mu(S_n) = \sup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mu(S_n)$$

For the fourth property, we use continuity from below. Consider a sequence $S_0 \supseteq S_1 \supseteq \dots$. Then we have that $S_0 \setminus S_1 \subseteq S_0 \setminus S_2 \subseteq \dots$, which tells us that:

$$\mu \left(\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} S_0 \setminus S_n \right) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \mu(S_0 \setminus S_n)$$

Now observe:

$$\begin{aligned}\mu(S_0) &= \mu(S_0 \setminus S_n \cup S_n) = \mu(S_0 \setminus S_n) + \mu(S_n) \implies \mu(S_0) - \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \mu(S_n) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \mu(S_0 \setminus S_n) \\ &\implies \mu(S_0) - \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \mu(S_n) = \mu(S_0 \setminus \bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n) = \mu(S_0) - \mu\left(\bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n\right)\end{aligned}$$

and via cancellation we have the desired property. Notice that the argument requires $\mu(S_0) < \infty$. If it were not less than infinity, then it may be possible that even the subsets of S_0 have infinite measure, which would mean:

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \mu(S_n) = \infty$$

which would give an indeterminate subtraction on the left hand side. $\square$

Furthermore, we can provide an equivalent definition for measure which does not require countable additivity:

Lemma 1.5. *The function μ is a measure if and only if it is non-negative, finitely additive, and continuous from below.*

Proof. $\implies$: This direction was proved in Lemma 1.3.

$\impliedby$: Consider a sequence of pairwise disjoint sets $A_1, A_2, \dots$. Then we have the sequence:

$$\left\{ \bigcup_{i=0}^n A_n \right\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$$

which is non-decreasing (satisfying our condition for continuity from below). Then:

$$\mu\left(\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} A_n\right) = \mu\left(\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \left(\bigcup_{i=0}^n A_n\right)\right) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \mu\left(\bigcup_{i=0}^n A_n\right)$$

By finite additivity, because the sequence is pairwise disjoint, we have that:

$$= \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \sum_{i=0}^n \mu(A_i) = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mu(A_n)$$

Now we need to prove $\mu(\emptyset) = 0$. By finite additivity and $\mu(\emptyset) < \infty$:

$$\mu(\emptyset \cup \emptyset) = \mu(\emptyset) = \mu(\emptyset) + \mu(\emptyset) \implies \mu(\emptyset) = 0$$

So we must assume non-negativity (if we try to prove it via monotonicity, it becomes circular). Then we have that:

$$\begin{aligned}(\mu(\emptyset) \in [0, \infty)) + \text{finitely additive} + \text{continuous from below} &\iff (\mu(\emptyset) = 0) + \text{countably additive} \\ &\iff (\mu(\emptyset) \in [0, \infty)) + \text{countably additive}\end{aligned}$$

$\square$

We can equivalently define a measure as:

Definition 1.5 (Alternative Definition of Measure). *A measure $\mu : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ has the properties:*

1. *For all finite collections of pairwise disjoint sets $S_0, S_1, \dots, S_n$:*

$$\mu \left(\bigcup_{i=0}^n S_i \right) = \sum_{i=0}^n \mu(S_i)$$

2. *For all sequences $\{S_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in \mathcal{F}^{\mathbb{N}}$:*

$$\forall n \in \mathbb{N} : S_n \subseteq S_{n+1} \implies \mu \left(\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n \right) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \mu(S_n)$$

We can now make this notion more specific to probability and say:

Definition 1.6. *A probability measure is a function $P : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ where:*

1. $P(\Omega) = 1$
2. *Given some sequence $\{S_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in \mathcal{F}^{\mathbb{N}}$:*

$$\forall i \neq j : S_i \cap S_j = \emptyset \implies P \left(\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} S_n \right) = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} P(S_n)$$

Lemma 1.6. *P is a measure on the measurable space $(\Omega, \mathcal{F})$ and:*

$$\forall S \in \mathcal{F} : P(\Omega \setminus S) = 1 - P(S)$$

Proof. Non-negativity and countable additivity follows by definition. We only need to prove that $\mu(\emptyset) = 0$. Simply take the sequence:

$$\Omega, \emptyset, \emptyset, \dots$$

Then by countable additivity:

$$P(\Omega) = P(\Omega) + \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} P(\emptyset)$$

Since $P(\Omega) = 1$, we can apply cancellation, which forces $P(\emptyset) = 0$.

This is a sufficient condition for measure spaces in general. Given a non-negative function μ with countable additivity:

$$\exists S \in \mathcal{F} : (\mu(S) < \infty) + \text{countable additivity} \implies \mu(\emptyset) = 0$$

proving that μ is a measure on that measurable space.

We prove the second part now that we know that $P(\emptyset) = 0$. Because of this fact, we can say that countable additivity implies finite additivity, thus:

$$\begin{aligned} P(\Omega) &= P(\Omega \setminus S \cup S) = P(\Omega \setminus S) + P(S) \\ \implies P(\Omega \setminus S) &= 1 - P(S) \end{aligned}$$

To do this proof, we require that $S \subseteq \Omega$ for the decomposition to hold. □

Definition 1.7. *If*

To motivate the use of σ -algebras, we look at a simple probability based example. Consider a weighted coin where the conductor of the experiment is not aware of the weightage. Then:

$$\Omega := \{H, T\}$$

However, our σ -algebra would be:

$$\mathcal{F} := \{\Omega, \emptyset\}$$

because $P(\{H\})$ or $P(\{T\})$ would not be known. We can make a more complicated example.

we fix our attention to subsets of $\mathbb{R}$. We defined the notion of outer measure of subsets of $\mathbb{R}$ as the following:

$$\forall A \subseteq \mathbb{R} : |A| := \inf \left\{ \sum_{n \in \mathbb{N}} |I_n| : A \subseteq \bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} I_n \right\}$$

where I_n is an open interval (or closed works as well) whose measure we defined as the difference between its endpoints $b - a$.

2 Random Variables and Distributions